Bao Tran Truong

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Center Synergy of Systems, Georg-Schumann-Str. 7a, 01062 Dresden, Germany

Education

2019–2025 **Ph.D., Informatics, Indiana University Bloomington, USA**
(Complex Networks and Systems, Minor in Computer Science)
Committee: Drs. Filippo Menczer (Chair), Alessandro Flammini, and Thai Le

2014–2018 **B.Sc., Technological Systems Management, Stony Brook University, USA**
(Minor in Computer Science)

Research Experience

2025– Research Assistant, Center Synergy of Systems, Dresden, Germany
Advisor: Dr. Philipp Lorenz-Spreen

2023–2025 Research Assistant, Swiss NSF Call for Regulation support In Social Media,
Advisor: Dr. Filippo Menczer, Dr. Silvia Giordano

2021–2025 Research Assistant, Observatory on Social Media, Bloomington, IN, USA
Advisor: Dr. Filippo Menczer

Awards & Honors

2024 Finalist, UC Berkeley Center for Human-Compatible AI's Prosocial Ranking Challenge ($6,000)

2024 Institute for Humane Studies Fellowship ($5,000)

2022–2023 Ostrom Workshop Fellowship ($49,150)

2021–2022 Knight Foundation Research Fellowship at the Observatory on Social Media

2021 Luddy Ph.D. Summer Research Award, IU ($5,000)

2019–2020 National Science Foundation Research Trainee (NSF-NRT) Fellowship

2017 First Place at the IEEE Student Paper Competition, Seoul, South Korea

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*Expected.

2017 Excellence Award, POSTECH Creative ICT Convergence Forum, Seoul, South Korea

2014–2018 Full merit scholarship, SUNY, South Korea ($120,000)

Publications

Google Scholar

† → Equal contribution

Journal Articles

J2 **Truong, Bao Tran**, Allen, O. M. & Menczer, F. Account credibility inference based on news-sharing networks. *EPJ Data Science* **13,** 1–19. https://rdcu.be/dxt25 (2024).

J1 **Truong, Bao Tran**, Lou, X., Flammini, A. & Menczer, F. Quantifying the vulnerabilities of the online public square to adversarial manipulation tactics. *PNAS Nexus* **3,** pgae258. ISSN: 2752-6542. https://doi.org/10.1093/pnasnexus/pgae258 (June 2024).

Peer-reviewed Conference Proceedings

C4 Aiyappa†, R., DeVerna†, M. R., Pote†, M., **Truong†, Bao Tran**, Zhao†, W., Axelrod, D., Pessianzadeh, A., Kachwala, Z., Kim, M., Seckin, O. C., *et al. A multi-platform collection of social media posts about the 2022 US midterm elections* in *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media* **17** (2023), 981–989. https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/ICWSM/article/view/22205.

C3 DeVerna†, M. R., Pierri†, F., **Truong†, Bao Tran**, Bollenbacher, J., Axelrod, D., Loynes, N., Torres-Lugo, C., Yang, K.-C., Menczer, F. & Bryden, J. *CoVaxxy: A collection of English-language Twitter posts about COVID-19 vaccines* in *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media* **15** (2021), 992–999. https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/ICWSM/article/view/18122.

C2 Pacheco, D., Hui, P.-M., Torres-Lugo, C., **Truong, Bao Tran**, Flammini, A. & Menczer, F. *Uncovering coordinated networks on social media: methods and case studies* in *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media* **15** (2021), 455–466. https://ojs.aaai.org/index.php/ICWSM/article/view/18075.

C1 **Truong, Bao Tran**. *Cognitive presence in Minecraft online discussion forums: how question framing affects subsequent discussions.* in *Proceedings of the 2017 CHI Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (Association for Computing Machinery, Denver, Colorado, USA, 2017), 190–195. ISBN: 9781450346566. https://dl.acm.org/doi/abs/10.1145/3027063.3048432.

Manuscripts in Preparation

W5 Can Seckin†, O., **Truong†, Bao Tran**, Menczer, F. & Flammini, A. *Predicting constructive conflict in social media discussions.* 2026. ICWSM, forthcoming.

W4 Kim†, D. W., Seckin†, O. C., Bhadani, S., Flammini, A., Ciampaglia, G. L. & **Truong, Bao Tran**. *Artificial intelligence can reduce political polarization by challenging partisan expectations.* 2026. In preparation.

W3 **Truong, Bao Tran**, Wu, S., Flammini, A., Menczer, F. & Stewart, A. J. *Community Notes are vulnerable to rater bias and manipulation.* 2026. Under submission @PNAS.

W2 Muralidharan†, R., **Truong†, Bao Tran** & Ahn, Y.-y. *Scaling of community rules across Mastodon servers.* 2025. Under revision @CSCW.

W1 **Truong, Bao Tran**, Kim, S., Samieyan Sahneh, E., Nogara, G., Verdolotti, E., Just, N., Saurwein, F., Luceri, L., Giordano, S. & Menczer, F. *Delayed takedown of illegal content on social media makes moderation futile.* 2025. Under submission @Royal Society Open Science.

Presentations

Talks

T3 **Truong, Bao Tran**, Lou, X., Flammini, A. & Menczer, F. *Vulnerabilities of the online public square to manipulation.* International Conference on Computational Social Science (Copenhagen, Denmark). July 2023.

T2 Pacheco, D., Hui, P.-M., Torres-Lugo, C., **Truong, Bao Tran**, Flammini, A. & Menczer, F. *Uncovering coordinated networks on social media: methods and case studies.* International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (Virtual). Apr. 2021.
– International Conference on Computational Social Science (Virtual). July. 2020
– NetSci (Virtual). Sept. 2020.

T1 **Truong, Bao Tran**. *Question Structures in a Minecraft Online Discussion Forum.* HCI Korea (Gangwon, South Korea). Mar. 2017.

Posters

P2 **Truong, Bao Tran**, Kim, S., Groesch, S., Verdolotti, E., Giordano, S., Just, N., Saurwein, F. & Menczer, F. *Quantifying the effects of time delay in illegal content takedown.* International Conference on Computational Social Science (Philadelphia, PA, USA). July 2024.

P1 **Truong, Bao Tran**, Allen, O. M. & Menczer, F. *News-sharing networks expose information polluters on social media.* International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (Virtual). July 2022.

Demonstrations & Tutorials

D2 Nascimento, F. S., Yang, K., **Truong, Bao Tran** & Zhao, W. *Exploring emerging social media: acquiring, processing, and visualizing data with Python and OSoMe Web tools.* International Conference on Computational Social Science (Philadelphia, PA, USA). July 2024.

D1 **Truong, Bao Tran**, Kim, S. & Nascimento, F. S. *Navigating the social media maze: recent research on social media.* Media Literacy Week (virtual). Nov. 2024.

Selected Media Coverage

2024 The New York Times, The Anti-Vaccine Movement's New Frontier. (CoVaxxy) [C2]

2024 AP News, How a Kennedy built an anti-vaccine juggernaut amid COVID-19. (CoVaxxy) [C2]

Teaching

2021–2020 **Data Fluency**, INFO-123, Indiana University Bloomington (IUB)
Assistant instructor — 50 students in 2020 edition; 57 students in 2021 edition

2022 **Social media manipulation 101**, IUB
Guest lecturer — *Web tool to visualize US Midterm Elections Cross-platform data*

2021 **Data Fluency**, INFO-123, IUB
Guest lecturer — *Machine learning methods to detect social media manipulation*

2018 **Computer Programming Design**, CSE219, Stony Brook University (SBU)
Assistant instructor — around 20 students

2017	**Foundations of Computer Science**, CSE215, SBU Assistant instructor — around 25 students

Academic Advising

2024	Rasika Muralidharan, IUB
2024	Jeneve Pilcher, IUB
2023	Oliver Melbourne Allen, Northeastern University

Academic Service

Reviewer	Scientific Reports ('24), ACM Transactions on the Web ('24), PeerJ Computer Science ('23), EPJ Data Science ('23)
PC member	ACM Web Science Conference (WebSci) ('26, '25, '24, '23) International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC^2S^2) ('24, '25) International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM) ('26, '24, '23, '22)

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